The Shooting Sensation

SURUCHI SINGH, 20
World No. 1 in women's 10m air pistol (ISSF 2025)
Jhajjar, Haryana

The only difference between her early days in the game and now, several world championships and staring contests with the bullseye later, is how much thought she puts in before starting. "Earlier, I would have a lot on my mind," says Suruchi Singh, the 20-year-old star shooter from Haryana who recently climbed an ISSF (International Shooting Sport Federation) World Cup podium for the seventh time. "Now I just pick up the gun and shoot. I can do it any place, anytime."

It's that cool-headedness—a calm detachment from the pursuit that has meant so much to her ever since a collarbone injury disqualified her from wrestling—that coaches have argued cannot be taught. Suruchi thinks a lot about technique, but intuition guides her pistol far more than it used to. Even in a sport so about being more accurate than your competition under pressures of time, "I never think about other players when I'm facing a target," she says. "I focus only on myself." That advice from her mother—her parents are her role models—has held her steady through years of highs and lows.

Her incubation period started when she was 13; she gained international fame six years later in 2025 with three back-to-back gold medals at the ISSF World Cup in the 10 m air pistol events, nudging Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker to second place. This came after topping the national trials in 2024, which itself was a result of feverish training after a crushing failure at the Olympics trials months before. "That was my lowest moment," she says, "but I trained hard to recover."

WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO
After years of rigorous training, Suruchi won three back-to-back gold at the ISSF World Cup 2025, shooting to international fame

Next stop is the Asian Games, for which she's not nervous, just excited. Suruchi follows a credo of unrelenting hard work, keeping one eye set on summits still unconquered. Usually she doesn't think that far ahead—"every match is my next goal"—but if she has one overarching ambition, it's "to wave the tricolour at the Olympics". ■

— Udbhav Seth

HER ADVICE

"To other women athletes, I say, work hard, dream big and let your performance speak for you"



Photograph by **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**